



Figure 6: Customised desktop with cairo-dock and Me Menu

the network when prompted. Later, it's easy to install and use Network Manager to manage your network connections.

Another crucial step is to select the applications to install after the base system has been installed, which you can do as per your needs. Figure 4 shows the available 'bundles' for various purposes.

After the installation is complete, it asks you to install the GRUB boot-loader. Choose to install it to MBR, then reboot into your new Ubuntu Studio install.

The differences between 10.04 and 10.10

1. The file `/etc/security/limits.conf` has now been removed, since it's no longer required by the JACK Audio connection kit, which writes its own configuration in the file `/etc/security/limits.d/audio.conf`.
2. PiTiVi: The default movie editor of 10.04 has been removed in this release.
3. The Ardour mute bug from the previous version has been fixed.
4. Other major software upgrades have been done.

64 Studio vs. Ubuntu Studio

64 Studio is a Debian GNU/Linux-based operating system that serves the same purpose as Ubuntu Studio. However, since it's based on Debian, the applications are sometimes outdated. Although 64 Studio is the more stable option, Ubuntu Studio has more updated software packages available. 64 Studio's release cycle is also unpredictable (the last stable release was two years ago). In contrast, Ubuntu Studio is released twice a year, like Ubuntu.

The pros of Ubuntu Studio

1. It is an official Ubuntu derivative. It is also supported in the official forums.
2. It has wide-ranging out-of-the-box 'bundles' of multimedia applications for easy installation, which helps users get started quickly.
3. It has a real-time kernel, which is an asset for audio/video work.
4. A set of custom themes are included, which are absent in the default Ubuntu install.

5. It can be easily transformed into an Ubuntu install, by adding or removing applications, and with minimum tweaking.
6. It is very economical for struggling artists, universities and schools.

The cons

1. It does not include wireless support or Network Manager in the default installation, but these can be installed manually. To do this, open a terminal and run the following command:

```
sudo apt-get install network-manager network-manager-gnome
```

Next, edit the file `/etc/network/interfaces` and comment out (insert a # at the beginning of) any line having the word 'eth0'. Save and close it; then reboot.

2. It also doesn't install the famous *Me Menu* of Ubuntu, but that package can also be found using Synaptic, if you want it.
3. It focuses mainly on multimedia use, and doesn't include Evolution Mail and Open Office, which are present by default in Ubuntu.
4. The lack of a live CD/DVD feature, and a graphical installer, can be troublesome for new users.
5. The default desktop looks odd and incomplete. It leaves you without even a bottom panel, which is present in all GNOME-based desktops.

Getting back the vanilla Ubuntu

If you prefer the look and feel of the vanilla Ubuntu, then you can easily transform your current Studio desktop into Ubuntu 10.10. Just go to *System > Administration > Synaptic Package Manager* and search for 'ubuntustudio-desktop'. Right-click on it, and select it for complete removal. Next, search for 'ubuntu-desktop'. Check the box to select it for install. Click *Apply* to complete the operations; then log out, or reboot your machine.

One might argue about the usefulness of Ubuntu Studio, stating that there is no need for such a derivative. Yes, it's true that you can, in fact, install all the applications you want in your default Ubuntu install. However, Ubuntu Studio is targeted at audiences who need to use multimedia applications on a regular basis, and may want to skip the pain of manually installing such apps—not to forget the fact that they also need to search for these apps, if they don't know the names beforehand. Ubuntu Studio provides a ready-to-use operating system that is fine-tuned for multimedia usage, and can be tweaked as you like. Figure 6 shows my current Ubuntu Studio 10.10 desktop, which has *cairo-dock* and the *Me Menu* installed—don't you think it looks brilliant? Give it a try, and I'm sure you will fall in love with it! 

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